

Describe the Scene

DIFFICULT PRACTICE

NAME _____ DATE SET _____ DUE _____

"Describe an empty theatre, ten minutes after everyone has left."

No characters, no dialogue, no plot. Build the picture entirely from what is left behind and what the space itself seems to hold now that no one is watching.

The hardest version of this task is describing absence itself — not just the room, but the feeling of everyone having just gone. A weak answer lists objects. A strong answer makes the emptiness feel active, almost like a presence of its own.

TECHNIQUE REQUIRED

- 01 Appeal to at least **4 of the 5 senses** — sound is unusually important here: what does silence in a large space actually sound like?
- 02 At least **one extended metaphor** for the emptiness itself (not just for an object) that you return to more than once.
- 03 One moment of personification given to something inanimate that seems to "remember" the audience — the seats, the curtain, the stage floor.
- 04 Contrast at least two specific leftover details (a dropped programme, a single house light still on) against the overall stillness.
- 05 Use at least one very short sentence (2–4 words) to create a moment of stillness or impact.
- 06 Shape: begin at the edge of the space (doorway/wings) → move inward → end centred on one fixed, lasting image.
- 07 Use exactly one semicolon and one colon, placed where they genuinely improve the rhythm.

YOUR WRITING

CHECKLIST — GO OVER IT AGAIN

1. **Is there a person hiding in this description?** Check you haven't accidentally introduced a character or dialogue — that breaks the task.
2. No clichés about theatres or empty rooms ("silence so thick you could cut it," "as still as a graveyard").
3. Every simile or metaphor fits the specific mood of *this* space, not a generic "eerie empty room."
4. Check tense stays consistent throughout — present tense works well for this kind of scene, but pick one and keep it.
5. No sentence longer than three lines without a natural pause — read it aloud to check the rhythm.
6. **Ending lands on a single image**, not a summary of what you've already described.